

Control Race Rulebook

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Changelog

0.1.0 - Initial Draft

Added

- Initial Control Race setup and objective rules.
- Standard snooker-style scoring values and exact-score win condition.
- Color control marks, control limits, controlled-color scoring, and control revoke rules.
- Snooker challenge declaration, resolution, and penalty rules.
- Penalty framework, including normal snooker penalties and the 30 point intentional foul penalty.
- Shorter and longer duration variants.
- Bookkeeping responsibilities for scores, marks, spotting, corrections, and table-state checks.

Setup and Objective

Setup

Place the six colors on their respective spots.

Place a single red ball between the blue and pink spots.

The game starts with cue ball in hand inside the D.

Objective

The first player to reach exactly 75 points wins.

On a turn, a player may nominate any color to pot, except a color whose scoring value would take that player above the win score.

All potted balls are spotted after being potted unless a penalty or challenge rule says otherwise.

Scoring and Turns

Ball Values

Points are scored using the standard snooker color values.

Ball	Value
Red	1
Yellow	2
Green	3
Brown	4
Blue	5
Pink	6
Black	7

Nomination

Before each scoring attempt, the player nominates the ball they are attempting to pot.

A color cannot be nominated if scoring it would move the player above the win score.

Control

Spotting

Every potted ball is returned to its spot after the scoring, control, challenge, or penalty consequences of the shot have been resolved.

Control

Marks

For every color other than red, players keep a tally of marks.

When a player legally pots a color that is not already controlled, that player adds one mark to that color.

Control Threshold

When a player reaches three marks on a color, that color is controlled by that player.

A controlled color cannot be marked or controlled by any other player.

Each player can control a maximum of three colors.

After a player controls three colors, that player can no longer mark any color.

Controlled Color Scoring

When the owner pots one of their controlled colors, they score that color's normal value.

The owner is guaranteed a minimum score of 4 points when potting one of their controlled colors. This means yellow and green score 4 for their owner while controlled.

When a non-owner pots a controlled color, that player receives no points for the pot. The potted ball is spotted and the non-owner's turn ends immediately.

Control Revoke

A player may revoke control of a color only at the end of their turn.

The player may revoke a controlled color only if their other controlled colors have an equal or greater combined scoring value than the revoked color. For this calculation, yellow and green each count as 4.

When control is revoked:

- The revoked color becomes uncontrolled.
- The revoking player keeps one mark on that color.
- Other players' frozen marks on that color become active again.

Snooker Challenge

- The revoking player remains liable to snooker challenges on that color until it is legally potted as the nominated ball by any player.

A player may have only one active revoke liability.

A player with an active revoke liability cannot revoke another color until the current liability is cleared.

Snooker Challenge

Declaring a Challenge

On their turn, a player may challenge a color controlled by another player.

A snooker challenge cannot be declared immediately after a non-potting safety shot.

Resolving the Challenge Shot

The challenger plays an extra stroke.

If the cue ball becomes snookered on the challenged color after that stroke, and the stroke involved no foul, the owner of the challenged color must play the next shot.

If the challenged color is potted during the challenge stroke, it is spotted before judging whether the cue ball is snookered.

Penalties

If the cue ball is not snookered, the initiator loses points equal to the challenged color's original scoring value, capped at 4 points.

Owner's Challenge Stroke

The forced challenge stroke does not replace the owner's normal turn. It is an extra stroke only.

After the challenge stroke is played, the turn continues normally.

If the challenged player pots the challenged ball, the ball is scored normally.

Normal penalties apply on a miss or any other foul.

Penalties

Penalty points are subtracted from the player's score, to a minimum score of zero.

If multiple penalties apply to the same shot or situation, only the highest penalty applies.

The following penalties apply:

- Normal snooker penalties.
- A 30 point penalty for any intentional foul or illegal shot made to manipulate score, avoid exceeding the win score, reset position, or create an easier route to the win score.

Duration Variants

Intentional fouls and illegal score-manipulation shots are arbitrated by majority vote of the other players.

Duration Variants

Shorter Game

For a shorter game:

- Set the win score to 50.
- Set the control mark threshold to 2 marks.

Longer Game

For a longer game:

- Set the win score to 100.
- Keep the standard control mark threshold at 3 marks.

Bookkeeping

Score and Mark Board

Each player's score and marks are managed by the next player clockwise.

After every legal pot or penalty, the assigned scorer updates the score and mark board before the next shot.

Any scoring or marking correction must be raised before the next shot is played.

Once the next shot is played, the board state stands.

Spotting Responsibility

By default, balls are spotted by the non-shooting player who is not next to play.

Players may agree to a different spotting arrangement.

The incoming player must check the table before playing. Once they play, the table position stands.